

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Global Warming - An International Problem!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read news articles from around the world?
- Which ones do you prefer? Business? Sports? Current Events?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about natural disasters in the news.
- I can write about cause and effect and hypothetical situations.
- I can write about how to deal with problems.





Let's Explore!

Sally comes across an online article while doing research on the connection between global warming and natural disasters. She discovers this **phenomenon*** reaches all corners of the earth, including "**Down Under****".

* A "*phenomenon*" is something that can be observed and studied that is difficult to understand.

** "*Down Under*" is a slang term given to Australia.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Global Warming Unleashes its Fury on the Land Down Under

Numerous communities in eastern Australia were devastated by massive flooding in the early hours of January 10th. In one small town, panicked citizens were forced to evacuate to their rooftops by a tsunami-like flash flood.

If the local emergency response teams had not been prepared with lifeboats and helicopters, there would have been a significant loss of life. The cost and magnitude are still unclear, though experts suggest that there has been significant damage to major infrastructure. Scientists fear that the Great Barrier Reef could also be in danger of receiving the runoff from the floods. They have suggested to the government that they should start redirecting polluted water away from this sensitive area. The floods were caused by the hot ocean water off the coast of Australia.

As water temperatures continued to rise, the atmosphere was filled with water vapor. If there is too much water vapor, there is increased chance of weather-related natural disasters and violent storms.

Shouldn't we, as a global society feel compelled to do more to combat global warming? With the support of citizens, leaders could enact laws that would protect future generations. If we all work together, we will create change.





Let's Practice!

Natural disasters can devastate cities, communities and Natural Wonders*.

The magnitude** of the disaster is still being calculated***.

*The Great Barrier Reef is the largest coral reef in the world.

**The size, extent, or importance of something.

***General idea about the value, size, or cost of something.

Instructions: Match the phrases on the right with the ones on the left to form sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1. Numerous communities in eastern Australia were | a. devastated by massive flooding in the early hours of January 10th. |
| 2. In one small town, panicked citizens were | b. forced to evacuate to their rooftops by a tsunami-like flash flood. |
| 3. The floods were caused by the hot ocean | c. water off the coast of Australia. |
| 4. As water temperatures continue to rise, the atmosphere was | d. filled with water vapor. |



Let's Practice!

The author makes a number of observations* regarding the violent weather and subsequent** reactions.

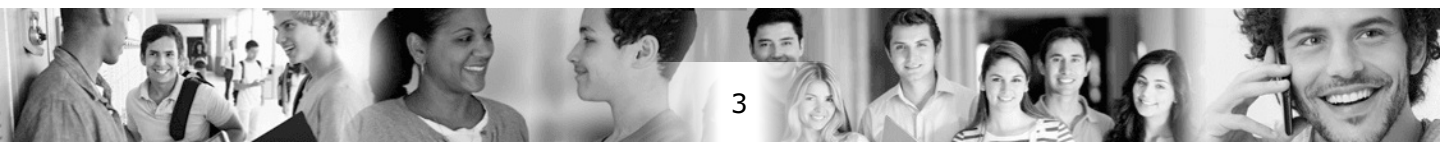
*An "observation" is a statement about something you have noticed.

**"Subsequent" means happening or coming after something else.

Instructions: Read the statements. Complete them by choosing an option from the box. Read the sentences aloud. Compare your answers to your partner's answers. Correct each other.

If we all / Shouldn't / there would've been / they should start / leaders could enact

- _____ work together, we will create change.
- _____ we as global a society feel compelled to do more to combat global warming?
- If the local emergency response teams had not been prepared with lifeboats and helicopters, _____ a significant loss of life.
- They have suggested to the government that _____ redirecting polluted water away from this sensitive area.
- With the support of citizens, _____ laws that would protect future generations.





Extension Activity

Time to do some research on a natural disaster.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research a natural disaster somewhere in the world that may be connected to global warming.
- Write down notes about the event. Answer *who, what, when, where, why* questions.
- Now, write a 100 word news article about the event.
- Include a sentence that explains cause and effect using *If*.
- Include a sentence that uses the Simple Past Passive.
- Proofread your work.
- Read the news article aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I research natural disaster online and take notes.

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☐

I write a news article about a natural disaster.

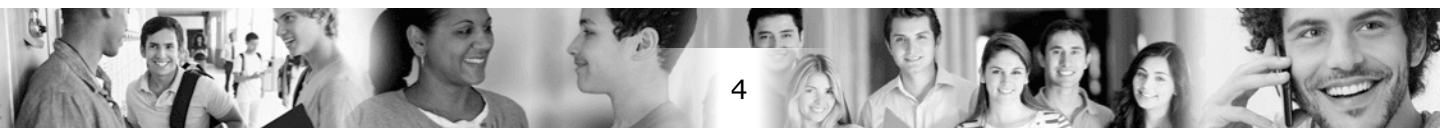
☐
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I include sentences that use cause and effect and the Simple Past Passive.

☐
☐


Target Words

- to devastate** (verb): to cause destruction, damage or harm
e.g. The violent weather devastated the community.
- tsunami** (noun): a very high, large wave in the ocean usually caused by an earthquake under the ocean
e.g. The tsunami caused widespread devastation.
- flash flood** (noun): a sudden, large amount of water covering an area of land that is usually dry
e.g. The flash flood caught citizens by surprise.
- infrastructure** (noun): the basic equipment and structures such as roads and bridges that are needed for a country, region
e.g. The wild weather affected a lot of major infrastructure in the city.
- drought** (noun): a long period of time during which there is very little or no rain
e.g. Australia has suffered many periods of drought.
- to enact** (verb): to make a bill officially become part of the law
e.g. Leaders could enact laws that would protect future generations.
- runoff** (noun): water that drains from the land to waterways
e.g. Scientists fear that the Great Barrier Reef could also be in danger of receiving the runoff from the floods.
- vapor** (noun): a substance that is in the form of a gas or that consists of very small drops or particles mixed with the air
e.g. As water temperatures continued to rise, the atmosphere was filled with water vapor.
- to compel** (verb): to make something happen; to force something
e.g. Hopefully, country leaders will feel compelled to act.
- atmosphere** (noun): the whole mass of air that surrounds the Earth
e.g. The atmosphere is made up of gases.





Learning Points

Writing a News Article - Simple Past Passive

When you are writing a news article or giving an interview, you can include the Simple Past Passive to describe something done by someone at sometime in the past.

Object + **was / were** + past participle

Example:

The weather was affected by the unexpected cold currents.

Was / Were + Object + past participle?

Example:

Was the weather affected by the cold currents?

Examples:

- *Numerous communities in eastern Australia were devastated by massive flooding.*
- *The hot ocean water off the coast of Australia was blamed for the floods.*





Learning Points

Writing a News Article - *If* Clauses

When you are writing a news article, you can also include conditionals to describe cause and effect as well as hypothetical situations.

There are different types of conditional sentences.

Type	When To Use	How	Example
Zero Conditional	Real Situation	Used to describe scientific facts	<i>If you put your hand in the fire, it burns.</i>
First Conditional	Real Situation	Used to describe cause and effect situations	<i>If it the weather is nice, we will go to the beach.</i>
Second Conditional	Unreal Situation	Used to describe hypothetical situations like wishes or dreams	<i>If I were a bird, I would soar above the clouds and fly to other countries.</i>
Third Conditional	Unreal Situation	Used to describe past hypothetical situations	<i>If I had known your house was damaged in the storm, I would have come over.</i>

Examples:

- *If we all work together, we will create change.*
- *If there is too much water vapor, there is an increased chance of weather-related natural disasters.*

